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## OpenAI Dev Day: The Cybersecurity Read-Through

We wanted to quickly highlight the cybersecurity read-through from OpenAI's opening keynote.

The quick 15 second discussion and single slide was uneventful and does not change our thesis on where frontier models are most likely to compete with or disrupt. While frontier model progress is real and should pressure parts of the cybersecurity market. We continue to see near-term disruption risk as more concentrated in discovery and **pre-production workflows**, including vulnerability and posture management, code security, and exploit path analysis, rather than in **runtime and post-production security** ([note here](#)).

OpenAI highlighted new capabilities for Codex Security, its AI security agent designed to identify, validate, and help remediate vulnerabilities in code. Codex Security is positioned to operate more like a security researcher than a traditional scanner. It can reason across a codebase, investigate potential vulnerabilities, attempt to validate findings in an isolated environment, and propose patches for developers to review. OpenAI also highlighted workflow enhancements such as scheduled scans. The key technical distinction is that Codex Security relies on language model reasoning vs. legacy signature-based scanning. Traditional signature or rule-based approaches identify known patterns associated with vulnerabilities, effectively asking, "Do I recognize this pattern as potentially dangerous?" An LLM based approach can instead reason about what the code is doing and how different components interact to determine why a particular behavior may create a vulnerability. This potentially expands the ability to identify more contextual, multistep, or previously unseen vulnerabilities that are difficult to capture with predefined rules.

**Clearly frontier models are becoming increasingly capable in vulnerability discovery workflows, but we did not hear anything that changes our view/risk to the core run-time vendors (PANW, CRWD, ZS, OKTA, SAIL, FTNT, CHKP).** The most direct pressure remains in areas where scanning for code vulnerabilities, configurations, and attack paths is the core workflow, vs. runtime security, where detection, telemetry, enforcement, and deeply embedded security infrastructure remain critical.

| Company Changes |                                   |          | Estimates |      |      |              |                   |              |                     |           |                     |      |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------|----------|-----------|------|------|--------------|-------------------|--------------|---------------------|-----------|---------------------|------|
| Symbol          | Company                           | Price    | Rating    |      |      | Target Price |                   | Current Year |                     | Next Year |                     |      |
|                 |                                   |          |           | Curr | Prev |              |                   | Curr         | Prev                |           | Curr                | Prev |
| AKAM            | Akamai Technologies, Inc          | \$108.99 | -         | OPF  | OPF  | -            | \$175.00 \$175.00 | -            | \$6.73 \$6.73       | -         | \$7.41 \$7.10       |      |
| CHKP            | Check Point Software Technologies | \$129.27 | -         | IL   | IL   | -            | \$130.00 \$130.00 | -            | \$10.45 \$10.46     | -         | \$11.41 \$11.29     |      |
| CRWD            | CrowdStrike Holdings, Inc         | \$259.25 | -         | IL   | IL   | -            | \$210.00 \$210.00 | -            | \$0.93 \$0.93       | -         | \$1.25 \$1.25       |      |
| FSLY            | Fastly, Inc                       | \$24.92  | -         | OPF  | OPF  | -            | \$32.00 \$32.00   | -            | \$739.61 \$739.61   | ▲         | \$872.41 \$824.67   |      |
| FTNT            | Fortinet Inc.                     | \$176.33 | -         | IL   | IL   | -            | \$165.00 \$150.00 | -            | \$3.44 \$3.15       | -         | - -                 |      |
| OKTA            | Okta, Inc.                        | \$202.18 | -         | OPF  | OPF  | -            | \$240.00 \$185.00 | -            | \$3.50 \$3.50       | -         | \$3.93 \$3.93       |      |
| PANW            | Palo Alto Networks, Inc.          | \$392.09 | -         | OPF  | OPF  | -            | \$415.00 \$415.00 | -            | \$3.84 \$3.84       | -         | \$4.17 \$4.17       |      |
| SAIL            | SailPoint, Inc.                   | \$20.57  | -         | OPF  | OPF  | -            | \$22.00 \$22.00   | -            | \$1071.42 \$1071.42 | -         | \$1270.89 \$1270.92 |      |
| ZS              | Zscaler Inc.                      | \$199.39 | -         | IL   | IL   | -            | \$155.00 \$155.00 | -            | \$4.24 \$4.14       | -         | \$4.88 \$4.55       |      |

Source: Company Data, Evercore ISI Research

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|--------------------|-------|------|----------------------------------------------|-------|------|
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| Buy                | 493   | 62   | Buy                                          | 95    | 19   |
| Hold               | 272   | 34   | Hold                                         | 21    | 8    |
| Sell               | 11    | 1    | Sell                                         | 0     | 0    |
| Coverage Suspended | 5     | 1    | Coverage Suspended                           | 1     | 20   |
| Rating Suspended   | 12    | 2    | Rating Suspended                             | 3     | 25   |

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